

Problem–Solution Fit Template

Project: Streamlining IT Procurement — Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Date	01 October 2026	Team ID	SWTID-2026-7609
Project Name	IT Procurement Automation	Maximum Marks	2 Marks

1. Problem Statement

Standard laptop procurement is often handled through manual request submission, email follow-ups, approval coordination, and repeated data entry. This can create delays, inconsistent request information, limited status visibility, and additional work for employees, managers, and the IT procurement team.

2. Target Customers / Users

- Employees who need a standard laptop for onboarding, replacement, or approved business requirements.
- Line managers and budget owners who review and approve requests.
- IT service desk, procurement, and asset-management teams that fulfil and track laptop orders.

3. Customer Pain Points

- Employees may be unsure which laptop model or request process to use.
- Approvals can require manual reminders and follow-ups.
- Procurement teams may need to re-enter request details or clarify incomplete information.
- Requesters and support teams may lack a single view of request status and next steps.
- Manual handling can make it harder to track turnaround time and identify bottlenecks.

4. Proposed Solution

Use Flow Designer to automate the workflow for standard, policy-approved laptop orders. A request is submitted through the IT service portal, validated against predefined criteria, routed to the appropriate approver, and then sent to IT procurement for fulfilment. Automated notifications and status updates keep the requester and relevant teams informed.

5. How the Workflow Works

Step	Automated activity
1. Submit	Employee submits a laptop request using a standard catalogue item or request form.
2. Validate	Flow checks required fields and whether the request matches standard laptop policy.
3. Approve	Request is routed to the manager or budget owner based on approval rules.
4. Fulfil	After approval, a procurement task is created and assigned to the responsible team.
5. Notify	Requester receives confirmation, approval/rejection updates, and fulfilment status.
6. Track	Request status and timestamps are recorded for reporting and process improvement.

6. Value Proposition

A consistent, trackable, and policy-based laptop ordering experience that reduces routine manual work, improves approval visibility, and helps IT procurement process standard requests more efficiently.

7. Assumptions to Validate

- Most laptop requests fit a defined set of standard models and eligibility rules.
- Approval paths and procurement ownership can be documented clearly.
- The service platform has the required request, approval, notification, and task capabilities.
- Non-standard devices, urgent exceptions, and policy violations can be routed for manual review.

8. Success Measures

Metric	How to measure
Request processing time	Compare average time from submission to procurement hand-off before and after automation.
Manual follow-ups	Count reminder emails or messages required per request.
First-time-complete requests	Measure the share of requests submitted with all required details.
Approval turnaround	Track elapsed time between submission and approval decision.

Requester visibility	Measure status-related enquiries or collect requester feedback.
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9. Problem–Solution Fit Statement

For employees and IT teams who need standard laptops, Flow Designer automates the request, validation, approval, procurement hand-off, and notification steps. This addresses delays and manual coordination by providing a repeatable workflow with clearer ownership and status tracking. The fit should be validated through a pilot and measured against the success metrics above.

10. Initial Validation Plan

- Map the current laptop-order process and record baseline turnaround time and manual touchpoints.
- Pilot the automated flow with a small group of standard laptop requests.
- Compare pilot results with the baseline and collect feedback from requesters, approvers, and procurement.
- Refine approval rules, exception paths, and notifications before wider rollout.

References

1. Uploaded source: Problem – Solution Fit Template, Project Design Phase.
2. Project-specific workflow details and success measures are proposed assumptions to validate.